The Italian name for this soup is *Minestra Maritata*, which simply means the flavors marry well together. Recipes vary, but it is always a robust, rustic mixture.

italian wedding soup

SERVES 4–5 **PREP** 10 MINS **COOK** 1 HR 40 MINS **FREEZE** 3 MONTHS

5½oz (150g) stewing beef, diced
1 boneless belly pork slice, rinded and diced
4oz (115g) piece of salami, diced
1 chicken portion, with bones
1 large onion, chopped
1 quart (1 liter) beef stock
1 sprig of fresh rosemary
1 bay leaf
salt and freshly ground black pepper
¼ head spring greens or 4–6 cavolo nero leaves, shredded
1 head of green or red chicory
2oz (60g) soup pasta shapes
freshly grated Parmesan cheese
crusty bread, to serve

1 Put all the meats in a large pan with the onion, stock, rosemary, and bay leaf. Season well with salt and pepper. Bring to a boil, skim the surface, reduce the heat, cover, and simmer very gently for 1½ hours until the meat is meltingly tender. Remove and discard the herbs.

2 Lift out the chicken, discard the skin, remove all flesh from the bones, cut into bite-sized pieces, and return to the pot. Add the greens, chicory, and pasta. Bring back to a boil, reduce the heat, and simmer for 10 minutes. Taste and adjust the seasoning, if necessary. Ladle into large open soup plates, sprinkle with grated Parmesan cheese, and serve with crusty bread.



CAVOLO NERO
This dark green cabbage almost looks black. It is popular in Italy, but you can find it in some speciality stores. It has a strong, rich flavor, and the best ones have firm stalks and fresh-looking leaves.